AUTHENTICATION CONCEPTS

View online: https://www.construct.net/en/game-services/manuals/game-services/authentication/concepts

What is the Authentication Service?

When you create a game, you will need to register players or allow players to sign in the game before they can interact with features in other services that require a player account.

Once a player is registered or signed in, a session key will be returned for this player. Passing this session key into other services allows this player to interact with other Construct Game Services. **The session key is private to this player and should never be shared or exposed.**

All players have a unique **player ID** which is a guid. Players also have a **player name** which can be displayed publicly. If a player signs in with a username and password it should be noted that the **username** is different to the **player name** and is only used to authenticate the sign in.

Registering Players

There are two ways to register players:

- Specific call to the register player end point
- Signing in a player with a supported login provider

If you register a player manually and **don't** provider a username and password, if the session key expires or is lost this player account will be unrecoverable. It is advised if possible to encourage the player to set a username/password, or link to a login provider at some point to ensure they can use this newly created account.

When a player signs in with a login provider, a new player will be registered if this player has not previously signed into your game. If the player has previously signed in with this login provider, a new session key will be generated which ties them to their already established player ID.